

Acceptable Use and Device Policy

Policy ID	IT-AUP-202	Owner	Information Technology and Information Security
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Users of company systems and devices	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines acceptable use of company devices, networks, applications, communication tools, removable media, personal devices, and software. Limited personal use is allowed when lawful, occasional, secure, and non-disruptive.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Activity	Default status	Required action
Install approved business software	Allowed	Use company portal
Install unapproved software	Prohibited	Request IT review
Use personal cloud storage	Prohibited for company data	Use approved storage
Connect removable media	Restricted	Security approval

3. Company Devices

Eligible employees receive role-appropriate equipment on or before the first working day when onboarding information is submitted on time. Users must protect devices from loss, damage, and unauthorized access. Hardware problems should be reported to IT. Users must not disable security tools, alter device management, or attempt repairs that could expose data.

4. Software and Communications

Software must be installed through an approved channel or after IT review. Communication tools may not be used for harassment, unlawful content, undisclosed commercial activity, or unauthorized disclosure. Users should verify unusual payment, credential, or data requests through a separate trusted channel.

5. Personal Devices and Personal Use

Personal devices may access company services only through approved controls. Downloading Confidential or Restricted information to a personal device is prohibited unless a documented exception applies. Limited personal use of company resources is permitted when it does not interfere with work, create material cost, violate law, or weaken security.

6. Monitoring and Return

The company may log and review use of its systems for security, compliance, support, and lawful business purposes, subject to local notice requirements. Users should not expect personal privacy in company records. Devices and accessories must be returned when requested, at transfer when replaced, and at separation under the Offboarding Policy.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Information Security and Data Handling Policy; IT Access and Identity Management Policy; Remote and Hybrid Work Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.